Composer OS

V4.0

QUICK GUIDE

Musician-Friendly Practical Guide



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Orientation: what V4.0 really adds

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

The musical point

Composer OS V4.0 develops a 24-bar piano source into a 48-bar orchestral varied reprise. Bars 25–48 reuse the piano material of bars 1–24; changing orchestral assignments create the reprise. It does not yet generate 48 bars of new piano development.

What is new

The documented V4.0 stages cover macro form (4A), motif and orchestration (4B), piano phrasing (4C), instrumental dialogue (4D), motif transformations and transitions (4E), dramatic arc (4F), review (4G) and Sibelius-ready notation/export (4H).

Start here

Choose an existing module, make a small musical idea, inspect its output, and then proceed to a larger arrangement only where the app supports the handoff.

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The desktop at a glance

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

Finding your way

The provided screenshots show Generate, Arranger, Structure, Ensemble, Grid, Presets, Outputs, RiffGen, Solo Piano, Piano to chamber, Composer Engines, Pentatonic, Hexatonic, BHL, Practice & Scales Studio, Evaluation, Development Studio, Slonimsky Etudes, Performance Composer and Help.

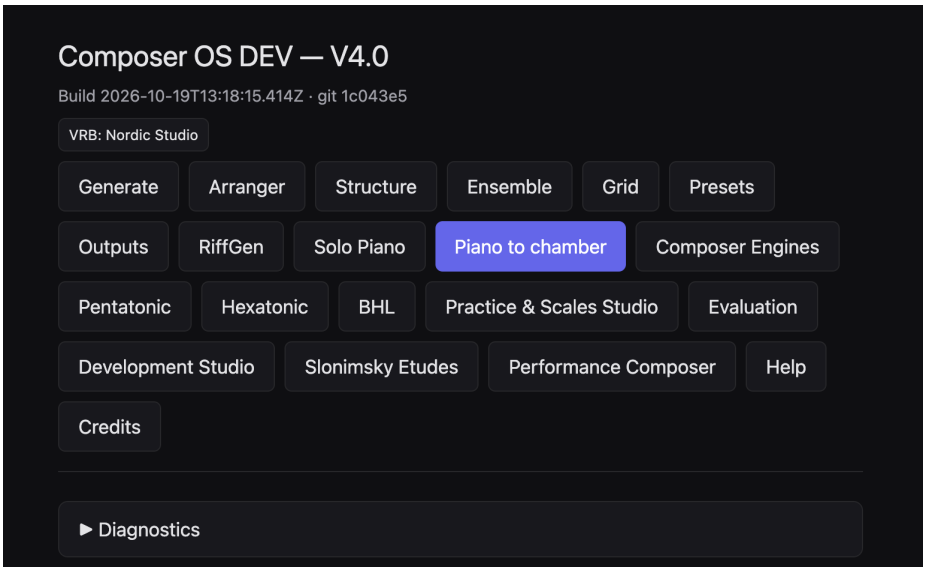
Navigation

Use the labelled tabs as your map. A visible tab confirms an interface area exists, not that it integrates directly with every other engine.

Important build check

The supplied desktop screenshots identify build git 1c043e5, older than the 4H source checkpoint 9f722ecb. Rebuild the DEV app and verify its displayed build identifier before expecting the newest release functionality in the desktop UI.

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First session: a safe musical workflow

Evidence: Musician-led exercise or practical guidance

1. Begin small

Open Solo Piano or RiffGen. Select an available preset or setting, generate or examine a short idea, then listen critically.

2. Evaluate

Notice contour, rhythmic character, harmony, register and phrase shape. Retain only material worth developing.

3. Export

Use the module’s actual visible output option. Where MusicXML is available, open the exported score in Sibelius to inspect notation, rather than assuming a passing test guarantees musical quality.

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Artist profiles and tiers

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

What the screen shows

Composer Engines includes a search field and filters Pinned, Recent, Premium, Strong, Experimental, Library and All. The captures show names including Donald Fagen, Debussy, Charlie Parker, Robert Fripp, Radiohead, Kenny Wheeler, Maria Schneider, Messiaen, Monk, Reich / Glass and others.

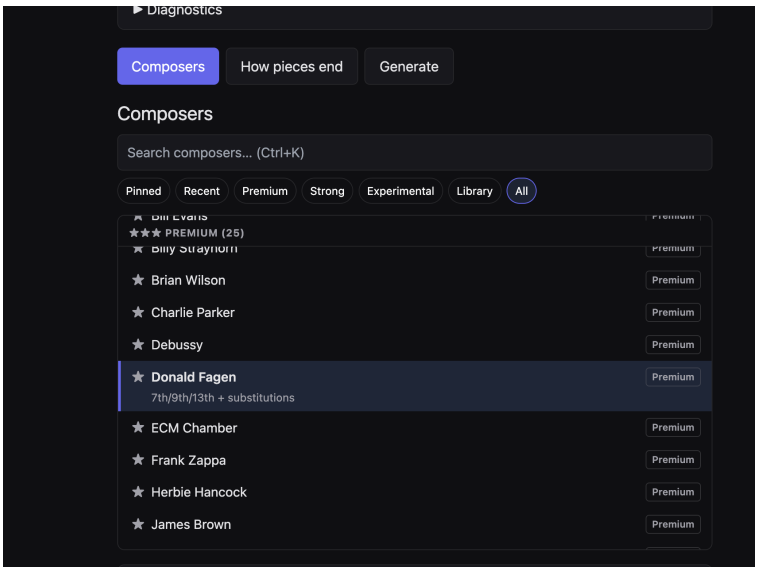
How to read tiers

Premium, Strong and Library are labels displayed in the UI; the screenshots do not define their technical strength or guarantee equivalent output quality. Consult each profile’s description and current controls.

Combining with other modules

Treat cross-engine style influence as unconfirmed unless a selector or documented implementation explicitly connects the chosen profile to RiffGen, piano generation or orchestration. The manual does not claim one-click universal integration.

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RiffGen: browse and make ideas

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

What exists

The pictured RiffGen interface exposes a 345-phrase browser, category and text filters, a needs-review filter and Style Pairings. Categories include bebop_jazz_blues, black_soul_funk, blues_rock, diminished_lines, jazz_rock, modern_rock, progressive_blues, sax_inspired, southern_rock, virtuoso_technique and white_rock_funk.

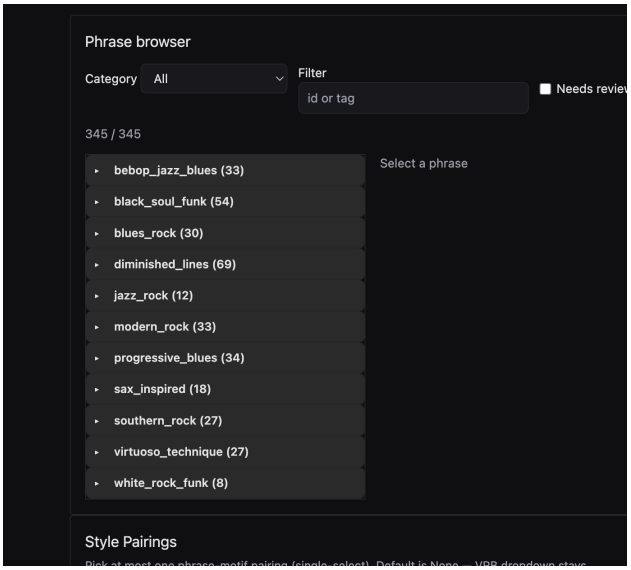
Crucial distinction

The screen explicitly says “Phrases.jsonl not wired into engine”. Browsing a phrase is not evidence that the phrase becomes input to the generator.

Creative use

Try a blues-rock groove, a modern-rock idea, a jazz-rock figure, a diminished-colour line or a saxophone-inspired response. Use the supported Generate route and compare the actual result with the browser selection.

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Pentatonic: melody and colour

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

Why use it

Pentatonic collections are a compact source of motifs, melodic cells and practice ideas. Composer OS has a named Pentatonic tab and a known Pentatonic Engine development history.

Musical exercises

Write a short melodic cell using five notes; vary its rhythm; play it in a different register; alternate it with a contrasting five-note set; then note which variations sound coherent.

Integration limit

A Pentatonic tab is visible, but the supplied evidence does not show a direct Pentatonic-to-V4.0 orchestration button. Export and transfer only via interfaces confirmed in your build.

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Hexatonic and BHL harmony

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

Six-note worlds

Hexatonic has its own visible tab. Treat named six-note collections as resources to explore, not as proof of a global cross-engine switch.

Bryant Harmonic Language

BHL prioritises colour, transforming harmonic material and retained common tones rather than default ii–V–I progressions. Previously documented worlds include triad pairs, harmonic quadratonics, major plus augmented, major plus diminished, pentatonic and unrelated major triads.

Try

Compose an eight-bar idea using two major triads with few shared functional assumptions. Retain one common pitch between neighbouring harmonies. Listen for the voice-leading, not a conventional cadence.

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Solo Piano and natural phrasing

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

What 4C achieved

Phase 4C developed more natural piano rhythms and phrasing around the 24-bar source. An immutable golden reference protects the original Phase 4C example.

Listen for

Short and long phrases, rests, varied note lengths and the impression of a single unfolding musical thought.

Exercise

Compare a simple repeated motif to a version with staggered entries and breathing space. The comparison is a listening exercise, not a claim that each edit is directly exposed as a UI control.

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Form, motifs and transitions

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

4A / 4B

Macro form shapes the wider plan; motif/orchestration work places and develops smaller cells.

4E

Motif transformations and sectional transitions help an idea remain recognisable while the context changes.

Exercise

Listen to three related appearances of a motif. Identify what survives (intervals, rhythm or contour) and what changes (register, timing, accompaniment).

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Piano to Chamber: the idea

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

In plain English

Take piano material and assign musical roles to several instrumental voices: melody, bass, inner colour and response. That is the musical idea behind the label “Piano to chamber”.

What remains to verify

The screenshots establish that Piano to chamber is a tab. They do not establish its supported instruments, import workflow or whether it uses the same V4.0 orchestration path.

What to look for

When the rebuilt app is open, inspect its inputs, available ensembles, generation controls and export choices. Do not assume the arrangement is performance-ready without checking ranges and balance.

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Development Studio: extend an idea

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

The question

You have a four-bar idea. How can it become music that lasts longer while retaining its identity?

Musical development

Possible musical techniques include repeat, displacement, fragmentation, inversion, contrasting answers and changed register. These are compositional ideas, not all verified Development Studio controls.

Verification point

The Development Studio tab exists, but the screenshots do not show its actual functions. Follow the options displayed in the rebuilt app rather than assuming it has every transformation listed here.

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Orchestral dialogue and counterpoint

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

4D

Phase 4D introduced instrumental handoffs, dialogue and harmonic support within the orchestral plan.

An example from the released score

The second half assigns distinct four-bar spans to combinations including clarinet/viola (25–28), horns (29–32), oboe/cello (33–36), violin II/clarinet (37–40), then violin I/flute (41–44).

Listen for

Who carries the melody? Who answers? Who holds the harmony? Does the arrangement leave space for the next speaker?

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Dynamics, register and climax

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

4F

The dramatic-arc work shapes dynamics, density and climax. In the 48-bar orchestration, melodic register peaks near bar 43; density climaxes in bars 45–47 before a reduced final bar.

What to inspect

Listen for whether the score earns its loudest moment. Verify that the thinner bars 25–40 support the intended build rather than feeling like an accidental drop.

Musical distinction

A dynamic mark and a measurable number of instruments are not the same thing as expressive musical drama.

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The 48-bar varied reprise

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

The architecture

Bars 1–24 present the first orchestration; bars 25–48 reuse the same piano material with different instrumental assignments. This is a varied reprise, not a through-composed second piano half.

Second-half map

25–28 clarinet and viola; 29–32 horns; 33–36 oboe and cello; 37–40 violin II and clarinet; 41–44 violin I and flute; 45–47 full climax; 48 quiet, reduced close.

Repertoire idea

Use the example to study how changing colour alone can reframe a repeated melody.

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Scoring review and BMEF

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

4G

The Phase 4G acceptance report documents score review. Technical tests and the user’s listening decision are deliberately distinct.

A useful listening checklist

Can you follow the principal motif? Are instrument entries convincing? Is the climax motivated? Does bar 48 release the tension? Are there awkward ranges?

A known concern

The handover flags cello register in bars 33–36 as potentially awkward. Treat this as a rehearsal/notation question, not as a verified impossibility.

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Sibelius-ready release export

Evidence: Confirmed V4.0 handover / technical checkpoint

4H

Phase 4H introduced contextual enharmonic spelling, release metadata and rehearsal marks. The successful final checkpoint was 9f722ecb, with 17/17 varied-repeat and 82/82 release/general-piano test results.

Score landmarks

The release uses title “Seed 77241”, composer Mike Bryant and rehearsal marks A–F at bars 1, 9, 17, 25, 33 and 41.

In Sibelius

Import the MusicXML, inspect instrumentation/transpositions, rehearsal marks, spellings and final barline. Listen through the score independently; a passing export test is not a musical endorsement.

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Other tabs: creative map

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

Composition and control

Generate, Arranger, Structure, Ensemble, Grid, Presets and Outputs are visibly accessible. Treat each as a separate area until its current controls are confirmed.

Study and performance

Practice & Scales Studio, Slonimsky Etudes and Performance Composer are visible. These warrant their own demonstrations in the comprehensive edition.

Quality and help

Evaluation, Diagnostics and Help appear in the desktop. Their presence does not mean they automatically certify a score’s artistic quality.

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How pieces end

Evidence: Visible desktop screenshot; actual controls may require inspection

The screen

Composer Engines contains a “How pieces end” view alongside Composers and Generate.

Musical question

Does the piece close decisively, fade, suspend, stop abruptly or return to something familiar? Listen to how ending choices change musical meaning.

Caution

No available screenshot shows the ending controls or rules, so this guide does not assert which ending types are selectable.

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Practical applications: 1–12

Evidence: Musician-led exercise or practical guidance

Ideas to try

01 Explore a blues-rock riff; 02 Compare modern-rock and jazz-rock categories; 03 Browse a diminished-line phrase; 04 Explore sax-inspired material; 05 Draft a five-note motif; 06 Create a contrasting pentatonic cell; 07 Compare two triads; 08 Make a common-tone harmonic change; 09 Produce a short piano sketch; 10 Listen for rhythmic breathing; 11 Try a more restrained phrase ending; 12 Open a result in notation.

How to interpret this page

These are musical exercises that use visible areas or established engines. They do not imply automated handoffs between modules.

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Practical applications: 13–24

Evidence: Musician-led exercise or practical guidance

Ideas to try

13 Explore a named composer profile; 14 Compare two style descriptions; 15 Filter to Premium; 16 Review Strong profiles; 17 Browse Library; 18 Inspect Experimental; 19 Mark a favourite idea; 20 Examine RiffGen Style Pairings; 21 Listen for repeated motifs; 22 Compare A and contrasting B; 23 Note an effective transition; 24 Evaluate whether a final cadence feels earned.

Do not overclaim

Profile tiers and style pairing affordances are visible; the underlying profile-to-engine influence must be verified for each workflow.

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Practical applications: 25–36

Evidence: Musician-led exercise or practical guidance

Ideas to try

25 Analyse a four-bar motif; 26 Compare transformed variants; 27 Listen for an instrument handoff; 28 Analyse sustained harmonic support; 29 Follow a theme across registers; 30 Compare two ensemble densities; 31 Trace the 24-bar dramatic arc; 32 Study the 48-bar varied reprise; 33 Mark the peak at bar 43; 34 Hear the climax at 45–47; 35 Inspect rehearsal marks; 36 Review the Sibelius MusicXML.

Progression

Work from a phrase, to a piano idea, to a form, to an instrumental treatment, to a score review.

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Limits and future development

Evidence: Musician-led exercise or practical guidance

Known limitation

The 48-bar piano material is repeated, not freshly developed for bars 25–48. New longer-form piano development is identified as future V4.1 work.

Integration ideas, not shipped features

Possible future work includes a common style-profile control across engines, confirmed phrase-browser-to-RiffGen input, richer piano-to-chamber handoffs and seamless developmental workflows. None should be described as presently working without source confirmation.

The best next step

Verify the relaunched DEV desktop version, document each visible input/output path, then update the examples that need a real cross-module connection.

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About this edition

Scope

Prepared from Composer V16 handover (21 October 2026), reported Phase 4H closure at 9f722ecb, and supplied Composer OS DEV screenshots. The source repository and newest live desktop build were not accessible for direct inspection.

Evidence key

“Confirmed” means documented in the V4.0 handover or terminal receipts. “Visible” means present in a supplied UI screenshot. “Guide” means a suggested musician-led exercise, not automatically implemented functionality.

Editorial standard

No undocumented buttons, input pipelines, artist-profile-to-engine integrations or unsupported 48-bar generation capability are presented as shipped features.

Artwork

Cover artwork uses the supplied guitar portrait and Third Sun Records logo. Tarot-inspired symbols serve only as decorative motifs; they are not Composer OS functions.

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Composer OS V4.0

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